

Portfolio

Yebeen (Bea) Kang | Product Manager

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Based in Seoul, South Korea · Open to relocation

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PRODUCT MANAGER / PRODUCT OWNER

Yebeen (Bea) Kang

Five years as a PM across a 7M MAU commerce platform, a new platform launch in France, and a B2B2C SaaS product. Lately I've been using AI to actively push out the boundary of what a single PM can cover. I want to work on products that stay connected to reality, and to widen the range of problems I can solve.

EXPERIENCE

kakaostyle · Commerce Platform Planning / Global TF
Jul 2022–Mar 2026

methinks · Product Manager
Jan 2021–Jan 2022

methinks · UX Research Intern
Oct 2020–Jan 2021

EDUCATION

Seoul Women's University · B.A. Business Administration
2016–2021

Tsinghua University · Exchange program
Aug 2019–Feb 2020

Strengths

I understand the product, the user, and the business

A platform creates business opportunity by defining and solving users' problems. When that understanding is thin, it adds product complexity and operational load. I go to users directly, close the gaps in understanding, and define the problem precisely. From there I set the product's direction, fast.

I look for my own lessons learned

A PM has to raise the quality of both the product and the collaboration around it, which means retrospecting on experience and keeping the improvements coming. I wrote up what I learned and what fell short after every project, and built a team habit of retrospecting together.

3. PROJECT · KAKAOSTYLE · GLOBAL BEAUTY TF

Launching a K-beauty platform in France

Product Manager · Dec 2025–Mar 2026

A new business buying from beauty brands listed on Zigzag and reselling to French customers. I defined the market, the target customer, and the product structure from zero, and launched within three months. I actively stretched the PM role along the way: AI-assisted research, building an internal ops site, and data scraping.

Launching a K-beauty platform in France

Product Manager · Dec 2025–Mar 2026

Background

K-beauty's popularity in Europe was rising, and with it beauty brands' appetite for selling abroad, so the company planned a new business line.

The plan was to buy inventory from beauty brands listed on Zigzag and resell it to French customers. I joined on the condition of finishing the launch within three months of the date I gave notice.

Launching a K-beauty platform in France

Product Manager · Dec 2025–Mar 2026

Action 1: scope the MVP to how local shoppers arrive

- Interviewed five French shoppers, pulled out the must-haves, and built to those.
 - How K-beauty and overseas products are perceived locally, and the purchase journey → hooks on the product detail page
 - What drives purchase decisions locally → inventory buying and price optimization

Two selling points

- **Prove that real Koreans use these products.**
 - French shoppers wanted to confirm whether a product was genuinely popular with locals. We decided to process and surface the user reviews accumulated on Zigzag.
- **Hold a price advantage over competitors.**
 - For the initial entry we bought inventory, so margin was ours to set. The strategy was to price below competitors, even by a dollar.

Action 2: closing the grey zones with AI

I built these myself with Claude Code, to speed up the launch and cut the operating load.

- **Competitor price and category scraping, and the reporting on it**
 - An automated pull of competitor products and prices, handed to the merchandising team, who used it for inventory buying and category structure.
- **Review data localization pipeline**
 - Built and shared a page that runs extraction of Zigzag's review data, prompting and processing, display, and localization QA.

Launching a K-beauty platform in France

Product Manager · Dec 2025–Mar 2026

Outcome

Sharpening the acquisition funnel and the MVP got the platform launched inside the three-month ETA, and it is running now.

LESSON LEARNED

Spotting the grey zones on the way to launch and working through them myself is what shrank the line around my own job. AI keeps widening what a single PM can cover, so when the product's goal needs it, I would rather execute across that line than stop at it.



Live creative from piyonna.com, the storefront after launch.

4. PROJECT · KAKAOSTYLE

Zigzag: Commerce Platform

Commerce Platform Planning / Product Owner · Jul 2022–Mar 2026

Zigzag is kakaostyle's fashion commerce platform, serving 7M MAU in Korea. I ran user research continuously, defined product and KPI roadmaps, and owned iteration, the backlog, and project management.

01. Seller Seeding Promotion

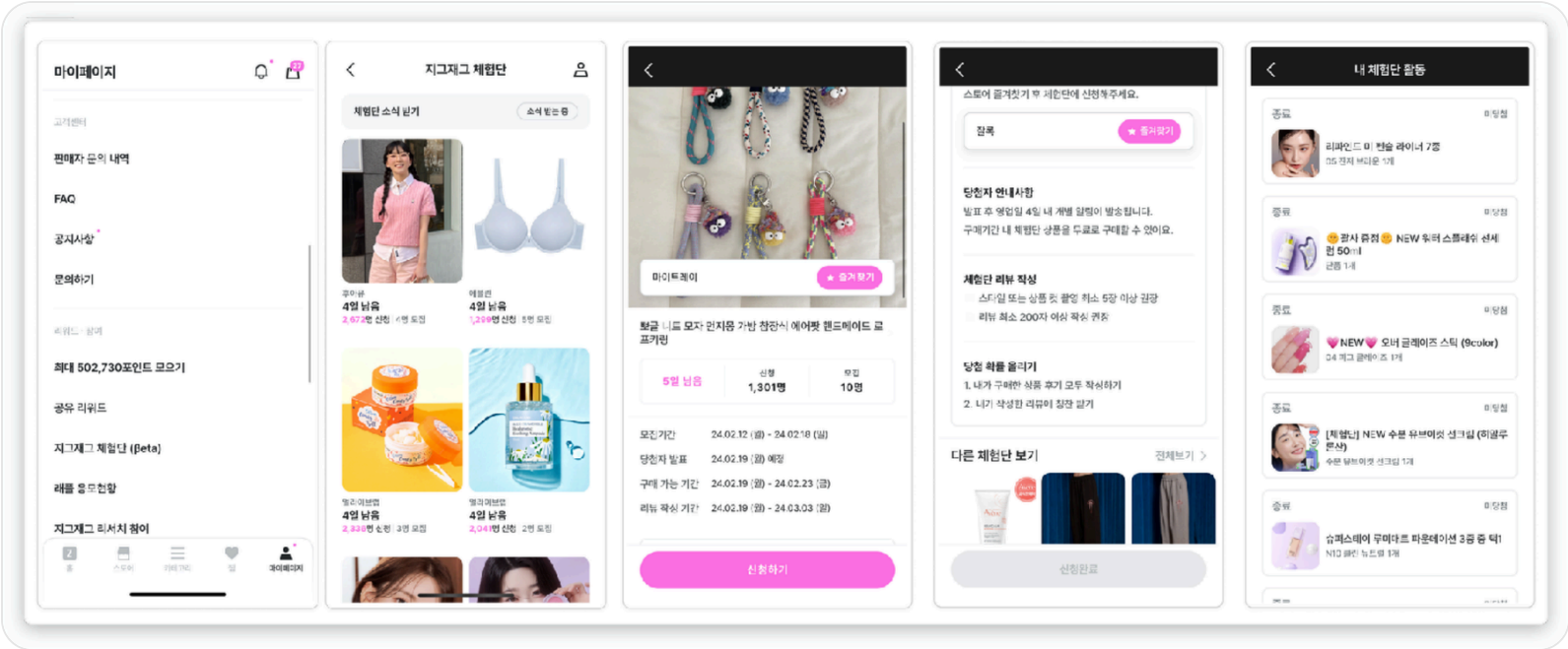
2024.03-05 / 09-10, 2025.02-04

Background

Cutting review-point payouts to save cost dropped review-submission rates by 40%. Reviews drive both purchase intent and seller sales, so we needed another way to generate them. Business teams were already running seeding manually every week, spreadsheet by spreadsheet (selecting products, recruiting users, booking placements, issuing coupons), which capped how far it could scale.

Hypothesis

turning seeding into a real product, productizing the operating cost sellers were already paying for informally, would recover review volume by leveraging what sellers wanted anyway.



01. Seller Seeding Promotion

2024.03-05 / 09-10, 2025.02-04

Action

Defined and led the full seeding product cycle end to end (seller application → selection → product exposure → user application → winner selection → purchase → review) and iterated on it using metrics and seller interviews:

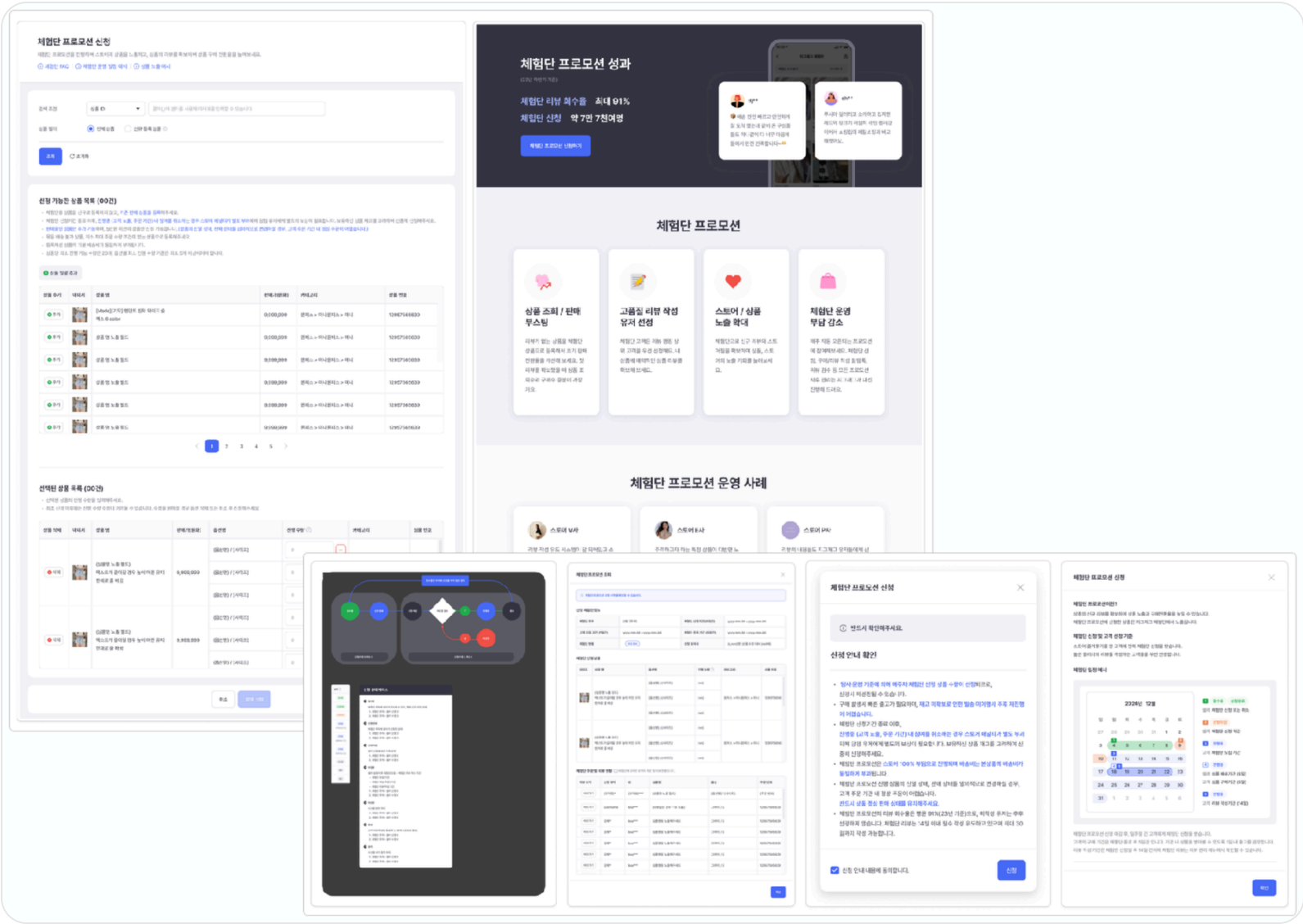
Seeding order-success rate fell from 95% to 75%

added a penalty mechanism that issues points when a seller fails to ship without notice, plus pre-order creation, recovering the success rate to 99%.

Reviews were slow to arrive

writing a review took 10+ days on average; a revised winner-selection logic and a daily reminder process cut it to under 5 days.

Also owned policy: winner criteria, per-cycle scheduling, listed-product conditions (quantity, shipping, attributes), order/settlement policy, and seller/customer penalties, coordinated with legal and CS.



01. Seller Seeding Promotion

2024.03-05 / 09-10, 2025.02-04

Results

Products offered / week

200 → 1,600

Participating sellers / week

10 → 100

Seller ROI (post-seeding sales lift)

+400%

Applications / week

30K → 300K

Review recovery rate

98%

Operating headcount

5+ / team → 0

COVERAGE

Dailian [Zigzag pilots a seeding corner to grow authentic reviews \(Korean\)](#) ↗

kakaostyle Partner Lounge [How the seeding promotion performed for real stores \(Korean\)](#) ↗

LESSON LEARNED

Product quality comes from iterating against users and metrics, not from a single launch. Shipping fast and fixing repeatedly, rather than shipping perfect, is what let the program expand into influencer seeding and an internal-employee segment.

02. Coupon Upsell A/B Test 2025.02-04

Background

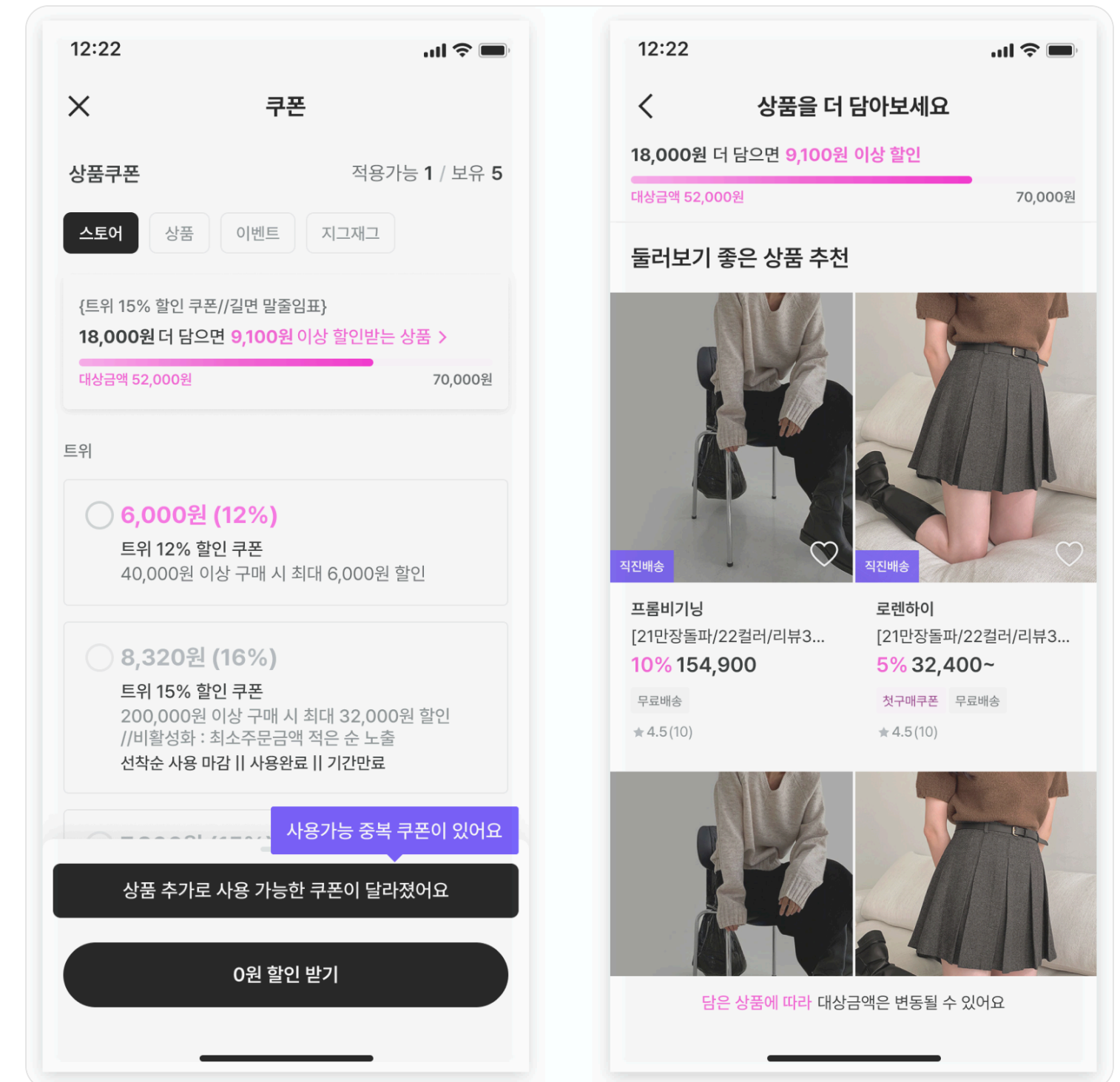
Outside promotion periods, average order value was trending down. An earlier cart-level coupon UI had raised coupon costs enough that it couldn't be rolled out platform-wide, so the goal became growing the AOV lift enough to offset the added coupon cost.

Hypothesis

a UI that lets users feel the benefit before checkout would nudge them into buying more.

Action

Designed the experiment: defined the recommended-coupon logic and what to surface (savings amount, extra discount, recommended products) and the funnel. Ran it by varying recommendation pattern (single vs. unlimited), timing (campaign vs. regular), and product logic (personalized vs. ranked) to find a winner, tracking average order value, item count, and cart additions with the data team.



02. Coupon Upsell A/B Test 2025.02-04

Results

Banner CTR

3.8%

Add-to-cart after entry

70%

AOV lift vs. added coupon cost

net positive

CTR came in low, read as weak initial framing and incentive, but the lift in payment per order (about ₩2,000) outweighed the rise in coupon cost per order (about ₩1,000) in the test group.

LESSON LEARNED

Maker buy-in decides how fast and how far an experiment goes. Winning over an owner worried about checkout usability took time, so the final UX shipped more conservative than intended, and coupon budget, a variable outside the product's control, kept the test extending instead of scaling. Now I settle the guardrails on what I cannot control and win the room before build starts.

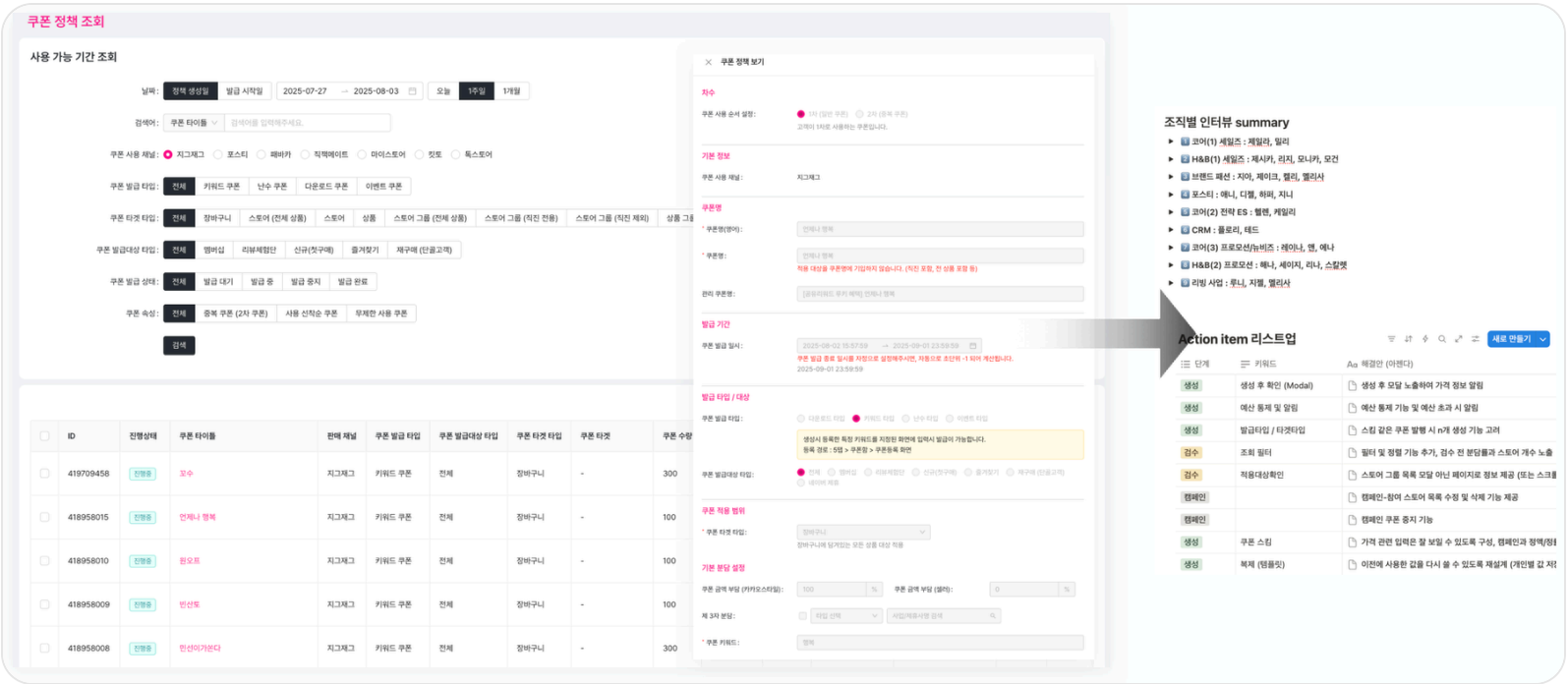
03. Coupon Issuance & Approval Overhaul 2025.04-06

Background

Five years of an admin tool built up through legacy patches had made issuing a coupon error-prone: 20+ misissued coupons a month, each one costing compensation, CS time, and product-team cleanup.

Action

Interviewed and shadowed the business team's actual coupon workflow to define the problem, then rebuilt the tool: review and approval steps scoped to what's being applied, faster approval paths, and terminology and hierarchy that matched how the business side actually talks about it. Led the cross-functional build end to end (backend, frontend, design, schedule, QA, release) and ran a company-wide session walking every business team through the new process, legacy data, and rollout timeline.



03. Coupon Issuance & Approval Overhaul 2025.04-06

Results

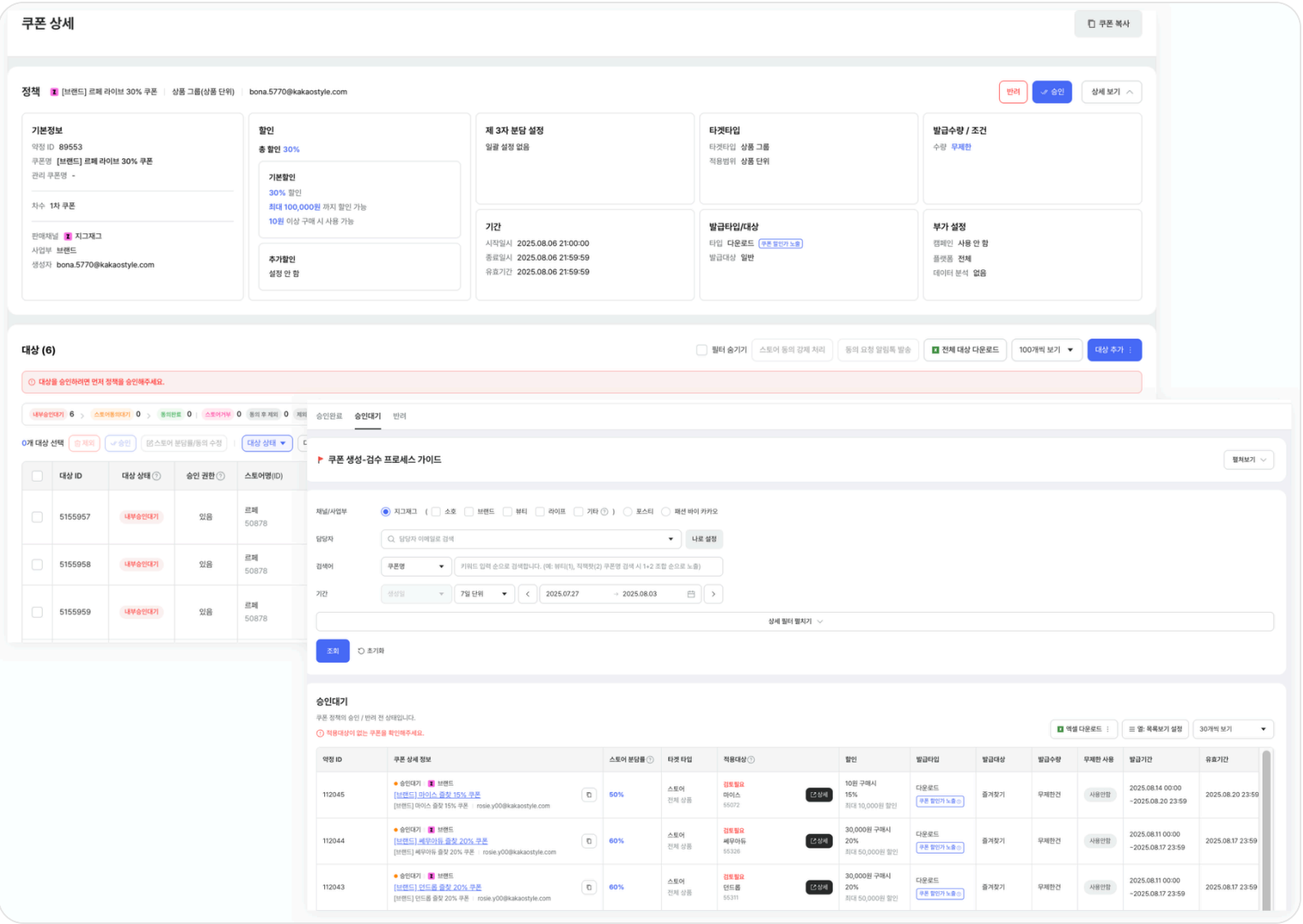
Misissued coupons

-90%

Freed up MD, finance, and product time previously spent on compensation and cleanup.

LESSON LEARNED

Knowing the seller and AMD workflow before, during, and after coupon creation is what let the process come together quickly. An admin built from watching the actual work, not from assumptions, is what saves users time. I still go find the user myself.



5. PROJECT · METHINKS

B2B2C Research Platform

Product Manager · Jan 2021–Jan 2022

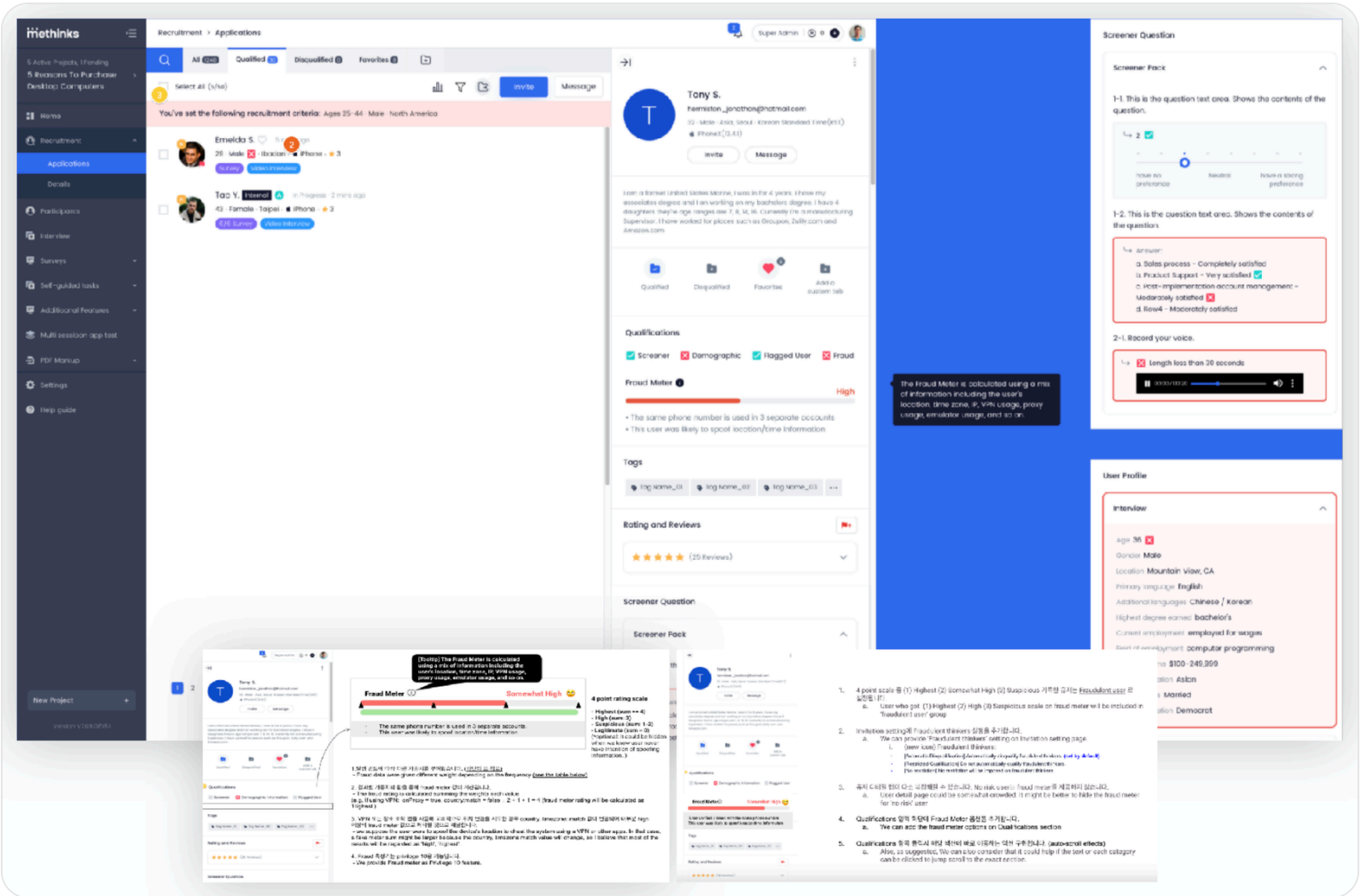
Owned feature design and business-client communication for a research SaaS web and app platform.

B2B2C Research Platform

Product Manager · Jan 2021–Jan 2022

What I owned

- Defined respondent-quality criteria and the filtering logic: designed a dashboard that measures interviewee reliability by combining a user's own data.
- Ran QA, and organized use cases and reviewed them with the team whenever a new feature shipped (U.S./KR).
- Collected requirements from internal and external clients and balanced priorities to raise productivity.



Recruitment / fraud-detection admin, and English spec documentation

B2B2C Research Platform

Product Manager · Jan 2021–Jan 2022

LESSON LEARNED

On-time delivery is the top priority

As a B2B2C SaaS, missing a committed date doesn't just affect one client relationship: it affects renewal and the platform's own revenue potential. I learned firsthand that shipping on time is a revenue lever, not just a schedule metric.

I understand the value of policy documentation

When enterprise clients used the platform, there was no document covering what each permission tier (super admin / admin / one-time) was allowed to do, or a detailed feature guide, so every question got answered verbally or by testing it live. Documentation was the first thing I prioritized after joining, and it cut out unnecessary operating time.

Thank you

Happy to walk through any of this in more detail.

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